

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

# list-steps

Vertical sequence of steps, each with full description body.

# What happens in the first hour of an incident, in theory.

## STEP 01

### **Declare and page**

Whoever notices opens the incident channel and pages on-call. Declaring is cheap; a missed page is the line item in the post-mortem.

## STEP 02

### **Assign a commander**

One person owns coordination and communication. They direct the response — they do not debug it, though they will be asked why they aren't.

## STEP 03

### **Stop the bleeding**

Mitigate before diagnosing. Roll back, fail over, or shed load first; find the root cause once customers are safe and the board has logged off.

## STEP 04

### **Communicate on a clock**

A status update every 30 minutes, even when it is "still investigating." Silence is what the retrospective remembers.

# Three phases, vertically arranged.

## STEP 01

### **Discover**

Interview eight stakeholders. Open questions only — listening for friction, not confirming the assumptions we arrived with.



## STEP 02

### **Frame**

Half-day workshop to align on root cause. Output is a ranked problem statement and a request for a second workshop.



## STEP 03

### **Decide**

Written sign-off on what is in scope, what is out, and what requires a separate decision we will defer.

## A four-phase engagement model.

### PHASE 01

#### **Discovery**

Eight weeks. Stakeholder interviews, current-state audit, and a problem-framing workshop produce a signed scope nobody rereads.

### PHASE 02

#### **Design**

Six weeks. Two design partners co-build the operating model and the change-management plan that survives until contact with the org.

### PHASE 03

#### **Pilot**

Twelve weeks. One business unit runs the model end-to-end with weekly retrospectives held biweekly.

### PHASE 04

#### **Rollout**

Phased by region. Pilot learnings shape the rollout cadence; the central team owns the playbook and the pager.

## Three milestones to GA.

### MILESTONE A

#### **Closed beta**

Five design-partner accounts live on the platform. Daily standups; weekly retros; one account that actually logs in.



### MILESTONE B

#### **Open beta**

Self-serve signup at the marketing site. Pricing visible but not enforced, which everyone treats as the real pricing.



### MILESTONE C

#### **GA**

Billing enforcement on. SLA enters effect. Support escalation paths published, then immediately bypassed by the Slack DM.

## Three tracks for the next quarter.

### STEP A

#### **Scoring hardening**

Per-team calibration, automated weight updates, and the recalibration playbook nobody has had to run land in this track.



### STEP B

#### **Audit posture**

Auditor evidence pack v2 and the decision-log audit trail ship for the Q3 audit window, give or take a window.



### STEP C

#### **Developer surface**

Signal-SDK parity and the new CLI flags close out an API roadmap that reopens every quarter.

## Three stages, with explicit stage prefixes.

STAGE 01

### Plan

Define the work and the artifacts each stage produces.

STAGE 02

### Execute

Run the work against the plan; track variance.

STAGE 03

### Review

Compare actuals to plan; capture lessons for the next cycle.

## Top three risks, ranked by exposure, owned by nobody in particular.

RANK 01

### Renewal cohort

\$2.1M ARR at risk if the pricing comp gap persists, which it has, comfortably.

RANK 02

### Pipeline conversion

11 pp below Q1; legal review is the chokepoint, as it was last quarter.

RANK 03

### Competitive displacement

Seven losses to one competitor in the \$80-200K tier, all to the same deck.



## Three engagement tiers.

### TIER I

#### **Strategic**

Quarterly executive review, dedicated success manager, and a roadmap they are shown but not promised.



### TIER II

#### **Growth**

Monthly check-in, shared success pool, success defined later.



### TIER III

#### **Self-serve**

Async docs, community support, and the hope that the docs are current.

## Three phases, roman-numeral counter.

### PHASE I

#### **Discovery**

Identify the constraints and the success criteria.



### PHASE II

#### **Design**

Sketch options against the constraints; pick one.



### PHASE III

#### **Delivery**

Build, ship, measure.

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## When NOT to reach for list-steps.

**Light labels, no body.** If each step is a single label with no description, use `timeline`. list-steps earns its chrome only when the body adds substance.

**Parallel options.** If the rows are alternatives the audience compares, use `cards-grid` or `verdict-grid`. The numbered prefix here reads as sequence — using it for parallel items mis-cues the audience.

**Author-typed step numbers.** Don't write `<strong>STEP 01</strong>` into the markdown. The badge is CSS-generated from the `o1` counter; manual numbering double-stamps and breaks on reordering.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

- `timeline` — shorter labels per step, horizontal axis instead of vertical cards
- `list-criteria` — gating requirements rather than a sequence of actions
- `split-steps` — phase label + heading on the left, steps on the right
- `roadmap` — phased grid across multiple workstreams
- `principles` — tenets or values rather than a procedural sequence